

Burners — Magic Examples

Every 1st-level working, ruled at the table — the World engine and the Combat engine, side by side.

A spell does what its entry says. Casting is never a roll to see whether the magic works; the roll, when there is one, prices what the working costs you or contests it with a target. The full procedure is on [[Burners Sorcerie]]; the catalog is [[Burners Spells]].

- **World engine.** Say what you do and the working lands. If the moment is risky, the Referee names a Cost — quoted against the outcome you want and the pressure of the scene, not the spell's level — and you roll **2d6 + Sorcerie** (Craft for Canting) to pay less. Small ask in a quiet scene, small Cost. No price on the table, no roll.
- **Combat engine.** Casting is one Action: burn at least SL Fuel dice (SL = the spell's level). Only a working aimed at an unwilling target uses the **cast total** — the target Defends, and overrun lands the harm or the effect. A utility or sensory working simply happens; extra Fuel past SL buys nothing there.
- **What the magic causes is a new question.** An illusory sound may call for a Morale check; a fog changes position and cover; a friendly face still will not open the vault. Those follow their own rules, and neither the cast total nor the caster's dice modify them unless a spell says so.

In the entries below, **Sorcerie** counts (a number of creatures, turns, feet) read as the caster's Sorcerie level — Craft for Canting — exactly as in the catalog.

Sorcerie

Read Magic

- **World.** A captured grimoire in a strange hand: cast *Read Magic* and the script opens — you know what each working is, and the book joins your readable sources. The plain reading is free; probing deeper for Facts is a Step-2 risk (see *Reading Magic* on [[Burners Sorcerie]]).

Detect Magic

- **World.** Sweeping the reliquary before the abbot returns: for Sorcerie turns, anything magical in sight glows to your eye, and you may ask its rough school and strength up to Sorcerie times. The sweep itself is free; if lingering is the danger, the Referee quotes the Cost against Heat, not against the spell.

Ward Pact

- **Combat.** You readied the card with **fire** named. Cast it as the salamander closes: for Sorcerie turns its flame bites you for –Sorcerie Damage. The choice that mattered was made at ready time — a ward named for blades is no help here, and the magic pact (the old *Parma Magica*) is its own naming.

Wizard Light

- **World.** Light on a shield boss before the stairs: it burns torch-bright, radius 30', for Sorcerie hours. No roll — light is the whole working. Quenching the guardroom's lanterns from the doorway is the same spell with a price; the Referee quotes what the sudden dark may cost.
- **Combat.** Cast on a foe's eyes it is hostile: one Action, at least 1 Fuel for the cast total, and the target Defends or is blind for 1 round.

Read Languages

- **World.** The smuggler's ledger is in cipher: for Sorcerie turns you read it plain — maps, codes, dead scripts, anything mundane. If the watchman's round is coming, time is the price the Referee quotes.

Cantrip

- **World.** Chill the wine, colour the hearth-flame, snap a spark into the tinder. Trivial and safe, so it simply happens. A cantrip never deals damage, moves real weight, or fools a careful eye — so it never asks for a roll.

Vitae

Animal Bond

- **World.** Touch the miller's hound at the hearth — quiet working, no Initiative. It regards you as a trusted companion for Sorcerie months (disposition, not a Muster slot; no suicidal orders). Roll against the Cost if discovery presses; Heat is the miller noticing, the dog following you to the gate, or the bond thinning when you are gone ([[Burners Referee Guide#Hostile magic outside a fight]]). If the hound is already set on you, roll Initiative instead.
- **Combat.** One Action, at least 1 Fuel. Preferred-speed beasts do not Defend — the cast lands. A Burner's animal with Fuel Defends; overrun makes the bond.

Animal Friendship

- **World.** Kennel dogs, petting, not under attack: they obey as a trained dog for one day — *down, quiet, stay*. No Initiative. Getting near under the handler's eye is the Cost; Heat is who saw, how thin the hold, or the pack breaking at dawn ([[Burners Referee Guide#Hostile magic outside a fight]]). If the alley is already hot, roll Initiative instead.
- **Combat.** Beasts at your throat: Initiative first, then one Action and at least 1 Fuel. Preferred-speed beasts do not Defend — the pack stands down for the day. A Burner's animal with Fuel Defends; overrun is obedience.

Beast Speech

- **World.** Ask the ravens what crossed the pass at dawn. Speech is all you get — they answer as their nature moves them, and persuading them to act is Heart, as with anyone.

Healing Touch

- **World.** In camp after the ambush, a willing ally above 0 HP takes **1d6** back, or one open limb wound closes. No Cost when nothing presses.
- **Combat.** One Action, at least 1 Fuel: touch an ally above 0 HP and restore 1d6. At 0 HP or less the card does nothing — that work is *Stanch*.

Joy Song

- **World.** The crew stands shaken at the barrow mouth: Sorcerie listeners shake off the dread, and each with at least 1 HP recovers 1. It lasts the scene.
- **Combat.** Sung with blades out it is still one Action and 1 Fuel; an ally gripped by fear or despair shakes it off as the entry says. Nothing opposes it, so extra Fuel buys nothing.

Light Shield

- **Combat.** Cast on Brand before the crypt door opens: blows by undead or unbound spirits against him suffer −1 Damage for Sorcerie turns, and a weak spirit's charm or possession fails against him outright. A willing ally is not a contest — no Defend, no cast total to weigh. #needs-playtest

Stanch

- **World.** The caravan guard is bleeding out on the road, at 0 HP or less: your touch restores **1d6 HP** and stabilizes him enough to count as help. Maimings stay closed to it.
- **Combat.** Sefa is down past 0: one Action, 1 Fuel, and she is stable and breathing. *Healing Touch* cannot do this work; this card can do no other.

Elementale

Crystal Growth

- **World.** Overnight, Sorcerie fist-sized crystals grow from the cell wall — hard as stone, worth little at market, and just the thing to jam under a door or brace a bar. Time is the only price unless somebody is watching.

Dragon's Breath

- **World.** Burning the web-choked corridor clear: the flame does what flame does. The Referee prices the smoke and the light — a Cost against Heat — not the burning itself.
- **Combat.** A 60' cone: every creature caught Defends separately against the same cast total, and overrun goes to HP (− AC if physical; monsters → Hits).

Fog Cloud

- **World.** Fog rolls out Sorcerie × 10' around you at the dock's edge and the crew walks out of sight. It fades in a turn; what the harbor watch makes of a sudden fog is the Referee's to price, if anything.
- **Combat.** No target, no Defend — the bank simply spreads. What it does to archers, pursuit, and cover is fiction the Referee rules on.

Heat Metal

- **World.** The strongbox's iron hasp glows until the wax seals run and the lock's temper goes — quiet work in an empty counting-house, priced only if discovery is on the table.
- **Combat.** One foe's sword glows hot: the holder takes **1d6** to HP (− AC if physical; monsters → Hits) each round for Sorcerie turns, unless they drop it. As written the drop is the defense — the spell offers no Defend roll.

Icy Touch

- **World.** Ice spreads across the millpond's sluice gate and seals it shut until thaw or hammer.
- **Combat.** Ice the flagstones between you and the charge: a floor cannot Defend. What slick footing does — a rush halted, a foe in the dirt — is the Referee's ruling on the fiction.

Web Weave

- **World.** Strung across the stream at dusk, the web nets breakfast by morning — a small ask at no pressure, **Cost 2–4**, roll **2d6 + Sorcerie** to pay less. The same web sealing a door mid-pursuit is the same spell at a far steeper quote.
- **Combat.** Webbing a doorway is placement: 1 Fuel, no Defend, and it holds until burned. Shooting the web at a creature is hostile — it Defends against your cast total, and overrun means stuck.

Thaumaturgy

Adhere

- **World.** Paint the ledge sticky and the crew climbs the overhang boots-to-stone, no rope. Washing is the only undoing.
- **Combat.** Sticking a foe's boots to the flagstones is hostile: Defend against the cast total; overrun holds them fast until washed.

Command

- **World.** “*Sleep*,” to the gate guard over a friendly word at the post. No fight, no Initiative — the word lands; roll **2d6 + Sorcerie** against the Cost, and Heat carries notice, a thin hold, or later reckoning ([[Burners Referee Guide#Hostile magic outside a fight]]). One word, and nothing that harms him. If the alley is already hot, roll Initiative instead.
- **Combat.** “*Flee*.” “*Drop*.” “*Kneel*.” One Action, at least 1 Fuel, Defend and overrun as any control.

Thaumaturgic Hand

- **World.** The key hangs on a nail across the portcullis: the spectral hand fetches it. Light objects only, for Sorcerie turns — it cannot attack or exert real force, in or out of a fight.

Filch

- **World.** The magistrate's seal sits on his desk; it is in your hand from across the room. Being caught holding it is the Cost the Referee prices.
- **Combat.** Filching the torch from an orc's grip is contested: it Defends against your cast total, and on overrun the light is yours.

Force Push

- **World.** The toppled column blocking the door slides away — an object of any size, pushed with the strength of Sorcerie men for one round. Noise and time are what the Referee prices.
- **Combat.** Shove the loaded cart into the shield line: the cart is the object, and what the impact does to the men behind it — a blow of situational dice, bodies in the dirt — is the Referee's ruling.

Leap

- **World.** The chasm is 30' and your Sorcerie is 3: you jump it. No roll — the spell is the bridge. A leap under crossbow fire prices the exposure, not the distance.
- **Combat.** Cast, and the movement comes with your Action: over the shield line and down behind the sergeant. The leap itself contests nothing.

Illusione

Arcane Eye

- **World.** The eye drifts down the stairwell and around two corners for Sorcerie turns; you count the sentries through it as clearly as with your own eyes. Scouting is the working — what you do with the count is the plan.

Auditory Illusion

- **World.** A watchman's whistle, two streets over, and the foot patrol turns toward it. Whether they bite is the Referee's read of the patrol — perhaps a Reaction roll. Your dice made the sound; they do not make the decision.
- **Combat.** One Action, 1 Fuel, and a nest-mother's shriek fills the gallery. The giant spiders' answer is a **Morale check** — 2d6 against their score, one roll for the pack — if the Referee judges the sound would frighten them at all. Six Fuel buy no louder a lie than one.

Bewitch

- **World.** Over a friendly talk, the clerk believes you are a close friend — no Initiative, no Defend. Cast against the Cost; Heat is who noticed, how thin the hold is, and what he does when it lifts ([[Burners Referee Guide#Hostile magic outside a fight]]). Disposition, not a command and not a Muster slot: he waves you past the anteroom; he will not open the strongroom, betray his master, or forget his duty, and asks against his interest run through Influence as with any friend. Proven otherwise — your knife at his ledger — and the friendship ends. If the room is already hot, roll Initiative instead.
- **Combat.** One Action, at least 1 Fuel for the cast total; the target Defends (an adjacent Sorcerer may Ward), and only overrun makes the friendship. The sharper's failed charm in [[Burners Examples of Play]] runs the whole procedure.

Blur

- **Combat.** Cast on yourself as the arrows start: while you move, every attack against you suffers –Sorcerie Damage for Sorcerie turns. Nothing opposes it — the working shaves blows on the way in; your Fuel still Defends them.

Visual Illusion

- **World.** A stack of crates that was never there hides the bolt-hole. Silent, motionless, no smell — anyone who touches or studies it sees through, so the Referee prices how closely the room looks, not the image.
- **Combat.** An illusory spearman in the doorway strikes nobody and blocks nothing. Whether the gnolls press past him is Morale or the Referee's read — the same routing as the shriek and the spiders.

Detect Magic (Illusione)

- **World.** The keener working: for a day, anything magical in sight glows and names its properties when asked, up to Sorcerie requests. Reading the hoard back at camp costs nothing but the card.

Umbrakala

Befuddle

- **World.** Over wine in his own study, the steward will remember nothing of the next Sorcerie turns — quiet working, no Initiative; Heat prices the gap someone else may notice, or what he does when the fog

lifts ([[Burners Referee Guide#Hostile magic outside a fight]]). If you force it under threat, roll Initiative and he Defends.

Cloak of Shadows

- **Combat.** In torchlight and gloom you fight at +Sorcerie AC for Sorcerie turns. It is soak, not stealth: blows still land and Fuel still Defends; the shadow just thickens the skin.

Darksight

- **World.** Douse the torches and walk the tunnels seeing plain, for Sorcerie hours. The rest of the crew still needs light — that tension is fiction, not a roll.

Deep Shadow

- **World.** A sphere of total darkness swallows the courtyard and the crew crosses under the walls. What the sentries do about a hole in the night is the Referee's call — perhaps nothing, perhaps the alarm.
- **Combat.** Dropped over the archers' platform it targets nobody and allows no Defend. Loosing blind into the black is the fiction the Referee rules on.

Gate Sense

- **World.** For Sorcerie turns you feel the thin places within Sorcerie × 100' — the sealed Kalla gate behind the crypt wall hums against your teeth. Finding is the spell; opening is another matter entirely.

Hatred

- **Combat.** Cast on the two bandit spearmen: hostile control, so each Defends against the same cast total, and those overrun turn on each other for a turn or until one dies. Cast where no fight is yet underway, it starts one — roll initiative first.

Necromantia

Animate Skeleton

- **World.** Sorcerie skeletons claw up from the barrow floor and dig, haul, and carry until told otherwise. Unarmed dead make poor company at a town gate; the Referee prices being seen.
- **Combat.** They serve as the Referee runs them: unarmed dead of the meanest sort — bodies to fill a doorway, not blades to win the fight.

Black Sacrament

- **World.** At dusk you open a vein — 1 HP — and bless your Sorcerie undead servants for the day: +1 Damage on every blow they land tonight. The price is paid at the casting; the fight just collects.

Blood Curse

- **World.** Mark the fleeing cultist and for Sorcerie days you know his direction and distance. Marking an unwilling man is hostile — he Defends against the cast total. A willing ally takes the mark freely, for the finding.

Blood Track

- **World.** The wounded wyvern bled as it flew: follow the trail up to Sorcerie miles while it is fresh. Following is free; what waits at the end is its own scene.

Marble Madness

- **World.** Your pockets refill with marbles every round for Sorcerie rounds — spill them down the stair behind you and let the pursuit find its footing. What marbles do to a running man is the Referee's ruling.
- **Combat.** Strewn across the flagstones they are ground, not a blow: no Defend, but a charging foe may end **in the dirt** if the Referee rules the scramble.

Wizard Mark

- **World.** Paint the junctions as you go: ulfire marks only you can see, at any distance, even through walls. The maze unknots for free; the card is the cost.

Canting

*Canting reads **Craft** wherever a count says Sorcerie, and rolls **2d6 + Craft** in the world. See Canting: Kicks and Jarks* on [[Burners Sorcerie]].**

Budge

- **World.** The warehouse's back door and its padlock click open — Craft locks at once, and no pick marks left behind. The Referee prices the noise of the door and the timing of the round, not the mechanism.

Cony-Catch

- **World.** One look at the fence and you hold a sentence of truth — his vice or his fear. The spell hands you the wedge, not the win: working it is a Heart squeeze like any other.

Flash Paper

- **World.** The job's terms pass from hand to hand as blank paper; only Canting-literate eyes read them, and after Craft readings the sheet burns itself. A dead drop that cleans up after — no roll unless the passing is the risky part.

Juke

- **Combat.** Dirty fighting in a card: your next Defend this round gains +Craft. Spend it as the bravo's knife comes in — the bonus rides a Defend you were paying for anyway.

Mark the Gull

- **World.** For Craft hours you pick out the most gullible or greedy mark in any crowd, and Heart contests against you fail. Choosing the mark is the spell; the con is still played at the table.

Mort's Mask

- **World.** Craft humanoids wear new faces past the gate — until one of them speaks. The silence is the discipline; the Referee prices the walk through the checkpoint, not the working.